

There are other types of quantitative strategies that neither I nor anyone else trading them would write books about. These are usually very short-term strategies or strategies with low capacity that would suffer or cease to be profitable if more capital comes into the same game. Medium- to long-term trend following, however, has massive liquidity and is very scalable, so it is not subject to these concerns.

Then there is another reason for me to write about these strategies. I am not a believer in the black-box approach, in which you ask your clients for blind trust without giving any meaningful information about how you will achieve your returns. Even if you know everything that this book aims to teach, it is still hard work to run a trend-following futures business and most people will not go out and start their own hedge fund simply because they now understand how the mechanics work. Some probably will and if you end up being one of them, please drop me an email to let me know how it all works out. Either way, I would like to think that I can add value with my own investment vehicles and that this book will not in any way hurt my business.

■ Ten Years On: A Second Edition

Well, here we are, ten years after this book, my first, was originally published and it has been quite a ride. I have to admit that ten years ago, I hadn't expected many people to be interested in a book on trend following by some odd European that they had probably never heard of. The overnight success of *Following the Trend* came as a complete surprise and it has been an amazing decade since then. Still to this day, the most common question I get, though usually phrased a little more politely, is whether I make a lot of money from writing books. No, certainly not, but that question is missing the point. Writing books is not only intellectually challenging and fun, it has opened doors I never thought I'd walk through. Yes, it has led to significant business deals over the years, which is a nice bonus, but what I value the most is the contact with all kinds of people I have met because of my books.

The books made me a frequent keynote speaker at various conferences around the world, and I very much enjoy the interaction and conversations I have had with so many people at these conferences. And there is the matter of other speakers whom I have met through such conferences, many of whom have become good friends. Back in the 1990s, when I was dreaming